

2. I am very glad to read what you say in paragraph 2 of your letter about Gandhi's fast. For it is clear that your general view is in entire accord with my own and that of the Governors. We are examining at the moment various points in connection with publicity that have emerged from the replies³ (the text of all of which you have had) from the Governors; and I will see that your point is considered with the others. But I very much doubt myself, in this country and given the degree of emotional excitement which would, in the minimum of time, be engendered by a fast by Gandhi, whether we could hope to be able to hold to a weekly bulletin or even to an interval of three days. We *might* be able to; it would be unwise wholly to exclude the possibility; but, in the light of previous experience here, I am bound to say that I am very sceptical, and I think that we should probably find that on the whole less inconvenience and less fuss and bother would be caused by putting up with a daily bulletin, and at the same time cutting down comment and severely censoring outgoing messages and incoming comment, than by a lag of the nature you suggest, attractive as that idea is. I feel great sympathy, on the other hand, for your suggestion that we should try to limit the space allowed for comment.

3. I was very glad to have your support over my letter⁴ to Herbert and his troubles. I am not surprised that the Bengal picture produces the impression on you which you tell me that it does! and if you heard some of the local comment which reaches me from one source or another, your feelings would be stronger still. Much of the trouble of course is, beyond any question, due to Herbert's own personality. Our predecessors were right when they decided that for a Province like Bengal a man of real quality and experience, such as Anderson, was needed (Colville I should have thought, with his far greater Parliamentary experience and intelligence, would have handled it very well). It is quite true that at the time when these appointments were made it was very difficult to get a really good man out of the Whips. But I do hope that it may be remembered when the next vacancy occurs: for if Herbert does manage to stay the course without some disaster until the end of his normal term—and as you know I have very often had most serious doubts as to that—there will be a great deal of litter to be swept up thereafter, and a man of strong personality and much experience will be required.

4. But that is on the specific problem of Bengal; and paragraph 3 of your letter raises the wider issue of the Swiss system. I do not propose to trouble you with any elaborate comment on that in my present letter. But I would, on the two central points that you mention, say that I feel very doubtful indeed about ballot secrecy in this country, and quite certain that no oriental will accept defeat in a ballot as final: rather will he start at once to recover by intrigue, blackmail and corruption, that which he has lost in fair fight! And,

with as much experience of the quality of the type of individual who might figure in a ballot as I now have, I would feel very uneasy, were I a Governor, at the thought that I might be required to choose as Chief Minister whoever came out at the head of the poll, *plus*, as you say, the next 7 or 8 in order in the poll as his colleagues. But the point is an interesting one; and though Provincial Autonomy has done as well as it has, we can none of us overlook the risk that in certain circumstances it too might be wrecked by politicians out here. In that connection I thought it well recently to put certain doubts to Glancy as regards the new set up in the Punjab (Please see my letter of 16th July 1943,⁵ copy sent by this bag; and Glancy's reply of the 20th July 1943⁶ of which a copy was sent to you by the bag of 27th July). But I should not be surprised if the Punjab situation needed, as time went on, rather more attention than it was necessary to give it in Sikander's time.

[Para. 5, on changes in the India Office; and para. 6, on the filling of the emergency vacancy in the Governorship of Bombay, omitted.]

6 August 1943

7. I thought your answers⁷ to Sorensen's supplementaries about Gandhi, &c. very adroit; they are certainly very helpful to us here, for they fill a gap which I very deliberately left in my speech in the interests of avoiding provocation, viz. the fact that so long as Gandhi and his friends continue to be detained for the reasons for which they have in fact been put in jail, we do not propose to talk business with them.

8. I mentioned in my letter of 2nd August⁸ that I had had a letter⁹ from Sarat Bose, and sent you a copy of it. I have now discussed with Maxwell and have checked up the information as a result of which Bose was detained. It is clear that much of this is based on sources which, I understand, we usually accept as entirely reliable and it shows that in the period before Japan came into the war he was taking a definite part in his brother's efforts, and was prepared to do a deal with the Japanese. I agree with Maxwell that in these circumstances his attempt to justify himself in his present letter cannot be regarded as sincere, and that it is more probably due to a desire to regain his freedom, and to get back to Bengal where he might, of course, be a danger in the event of any Japanese attack in that direction. It is evident from the 5th paragraph of his present letter that his attitude towards Japan fluctuates according to the likelihood of a successful invasion. It may be that Bose, seeing the way open, wishes to come out as a new leader in Indian politics. But there is no indication in his letter that he has any more constructive proposals than we have heard from

³ MSS. EUR. F. 125/III.

⁴ No. 26.

⁵ No. 49.

⁶ No. 55.

⁷ See No. 68, note 7.

⁸ No. 68.

⁹ No. 50.

such persons as the non-party leaders. In the circumstances, and after full discussion with Maxwell, I decided that it would not be wise for me to have any correspondence or dealings with him, and I have had a formal reply sent to him to the effect that so long as the grounds for his detention remain I do not propose to discuss matters with him.

9. Spens has been kind enough to let me see a copy of his letter to you of the 6th August¹⁰ which goes by this bag, and in which he discusses the extension of the jurisdiction of the Federal Court. I do not think that there is anything that I need say. There is obvious advantage in Wavell having the chance to talk the position over with you before he comes out. My own view is, I think, sufficiently clear from our earlier correspondence.¹¹ It is briefly that I have no objection in principle to the extension, and am very anxious to do anything that wisely can be done to enhance the prestige of the Federal Court. But I am bound, in a technical matter of this kind, to pay due deference to the views of those competent to advise, and, in present circumstances, to their feeling that the time is not yet ripe. I express no opinion myself as to when the proper time would be—it may be only a matter of a few months. But things may have begun to take shape a little by the time Wavell gets out here. In particular the Court will have had an opportunity of trying some cases under Spens' presidency, and if the result is impressive the establishment of the requisite degree of confidence in the Court and its personnel may be swifter than would otherwise be the case.

9 August 1943

10. Your letter of the 28th July¹² has just arrived. Many thanks for it. The point you raise in its opening paragraph about Indian sterling balances is obviously of very great importance and delicacy, and I am most grateful to you for giving me this early warning that we may hear more about it. I do not propose to comment at any length at this stage, but I will have a word with Raisman and let him know how the wind seems to be blowing.

11. I have been very glad to see Mudaliar. He is staying with me here for a few days, and I have also had a couple of good talks with him. I think that his time in London has done him a great deal of good. I always had a high opinion of his intelligence and his capacity for stating a case. But I am inclined to think, though it is too early yet to judge, that the effect of these different contacts and of his association with the Cabinet, &c. has been to broaden him. I dare say that he may think it wise in the political field, knowing as he does that nothing much can happen in these last few weeks of my time, to save his powder and shot for Wavell! Anyhow he has so far shown no sign of wishing to raise any political issues, and has not even touched on matters such as further Indianisation, &c. Incidentally, on that latter point, I am interested to see an increasing degree of criticism of the existing Indianisation of my Council on the ground that it

has no real popular value, and that if this is the best we can do it would have been much better to have left things alone. I do not take all that very seriously. I doubt if there is much real foundation for these rather peevish comments, and I am quite certain that the body I have been able to get together, even if in some ways it is not as strong as it might be, is thoroughly representative, and that its existence serves as a very useful safety-valve for certain feelings, and a definite reassurance to the moderate-minded and reasonable in this country. And as for the satisfaction with their representation in it of the minorities such as the Sikhs and Scheduled Castes, there can I think be no question.

[Para. 12, on the project for an Empire commercial union; and para. 13, on Mr Shamaldhari Lall's prospects, omitted.]

14. It is very kind of you to have sent me your Legal Adviser's note which you mention in paragraph 6 of your letter. I was interested to read it and am grateful to him for it (I think incidentally he has misunderstood me on one point in his paragraph 2.¹³ My trouble is not that on the matter in issue the legal advice I receive is bad, but that I have *no* legal advice, as I think I explained in my earlier letter). I think things are easing rather, and I hope, once Spens gets into the saddle, and once he has been able to make contact with the various High Courts, &c., that that will help further to ease any existing tension. It is a great relief, as you say, to have got through these contempt cases safely. I was interested, incidentally, in the recent Privy Council judgment about a contempt case which came up from the Allahabad High Court.

15. You ask in the last paragraph of your letter what has been the Indian reaction to Mussolini's downfall. It has been one of very real and genuine satisfaction. Largely, I think, because Indian public opinion rightly judges the collapse of Mussolini and the abandonment of Fascism as a very clear indication of the approaching end of the war in Europe, and an outstanding tribute to our success in that campaign. But also because of the fairly deeply-rooted Indian aversion to Fascism as a political ideal (an aversion quite consistent with the adoption from time to time in politics of methods very little distinguishable from the best Fascist methods!). There is much satisfaction, too, at the part which Indian troops have played, both in the North African campaign which led up to the attack on Italy, and in these last few days apparently in Sicily itself.

¹⁰ L/P&J/8/458. ¹¹ Not printed. ¹² No. 64.

¹³ This para. commented on Lord Linlithgow's suggestion (in No. 18, para. 13) that H.M.G. might be invited to send out a High Court judge to investigate the Indian judicial system. It read: 'As to the other suggestion made by the Viceroy—which would appear to owe its origin to a lack of confidence in the legal advice at present available to him—there would of course be no sanction behind any course of action based on advice given by the "experienced High Court Judge" save that it would be founded on the highest legal opinion and experience. There is no guarantee that, as such, it would necessarily find favour with the High Court.' L/P&J/8/633.

10 August 1943

16. I am becoming seriously uneasy about the Bengal position, and I have telegraphed¹⁴ to warn you of that. I am forming the strong impression that Herbert has no real control of what is going on, and that the administration is deteriorating very rapidly. I know that he has a very indifferent lot of Ministers, but either he does not keep in sufficiently close touch, through his official Secretaries, with what they are doing, or he is unable to keep them on the right lines. One fatal defect from which Herbert suffers in extreme degree is that he will insist on doing all the talking himself. I am told confidentially that his cabinet meetings consist very often of little more than an interminable and rather muddled homily by the Governor, which leaves the Ministers with their own words lying heavy on their chests, while the Governor fails to inform himself of the views of his Ministers. Bad administration is of particular importance in connection with food, which is such a delicate business at the present time. A report¹⁵ which I have seen from Braund makes it clear that the local atmosphere is far from satisfactory in that regard. And he comments that there exists no adequate organisation at present to supply, or feed, or ration Calcutta, the second largest city in the Empire, even before alarm occurs, and still less afterwards; and that no provincial organisation exists to carry this out. Meanwhile the Ministers' idea of handling food has been to complain bitterly and try to get as much as they can out of the Centre. They are of course perfectly entitled to get what they can, but if there is to be any progress far more active assistance from Ministers themselves must be looked for. You should see, in this connection, the copy I send you by this bag of a letter¹⁶ from Wood, my Food Secretary, to Suhrawardy, the Minister in charge of food, which speaks for itself. Over sugar distribution, again, there seems to be a thoroughly unsatisfactory situation in Calcutta. I have dealt with it in some detail in a letter which I sent yesterday¹⁷ to Herbert, and a copy of which goes to you by the bag. As for the financial position in Bengal, I thought it well to ask Raisman, who has expressed himself in terms of great concern at the way things are moving, for a note of his views in case I should have to telegraph to you. I enclose in this letter copy of the note¹⁸ he has let me have. It speaks for itself. I may of course have to include it or the gist of it in a telegram, but would like you to see it *in extenso*.

17. Part of the trouble is, no doubt, that the I.C.S. in Bengal, though much better than in the adjoining province of Bihar, is not of the highest quality. The crucial fact is I suspect that for this most important and difficult province one needs a Governor of very different calibre from Herbert. I do not think I can be accused of having treated him with any lack of care or consideration—as our correspondence over recent years will show, he has on two or three occasions been the subject of most serious concern to me, and I have had to

consider whether a change would not be in the general interest. I have continued, partly from perhaps an undue desire not to be hard on Herbert, partly in the sincere hope that there might be an improvement, to carry on and advise you that we were justified in doing so. But I am bound to say that as matters stand now I very gravely doubt whether a change is not called for, and I shall probably telegraph to you on this subject, once I have made up my mind, before you get this letter.

18. If there is to be a change I feel that it would be fairer to Wavell that I should carry the burden of it, than that he should have to face up to any insufficiency on Herbert's part shortly after taking over himself as Viceroy. And it is arguable, that if there is to be a change, to make it without delay so that the new man can have found his feet before the next year's campaign begins to develop. Lady Mary's illness would probably provide us with cover of the type that would readily be accepted by the public, and that might indeed result in Herbert handing over with some public sympathy. I need not say how unpleasant a business it is to have to consider this sort of change; and you and I have been singularly unfortunate in that, if Herbert does go, we shall have had to consider it twice within a few months. But the interests at stake, particularly given the war position, are too important for personal considerations to weight the scale, though if I do decide to recommend that Herbert be relieved, and you accept my recommendation, we should, I am sure, both of us be most anxious to make things as smooth for him over his handing over as possible. It might be necessary to consider an acting Governor for a short time, if, as I imagine is not unlikely, you were to have difficulty in finding at short notice a suitable Parliamentary successor. But we need not consider that for the moment. All I would most earnestly beg you to ensure if there is a change is that we get a good man. Herbert has been too close a repetition of Stanley Jackson, and it is increasingly clear that we just cannot afford to take back-benchers of no particular quality for posts such as these, which require energy, decision and intelligence, and the capacity in addition to handle Ministers. And while that would be true in peace-time, it is most markedly the case with Bengal in the front line and a most important base for the forthcoming campaign against the Japanese. I am sure that we have been very lucky in getting Colville for Bombay, and that is very much the type of man that will, I should have thought, in almost all circumstances be needed for Bengal.

19. At the first Council meeting after Mudaliar's return I took up the question of Indian representation at the War Cabinet, having previously had

¹⁴ 1693-S of 9 August. MSS. EUR. F. 125/25. ¹⁵ Not printed.

¹⁶ Denying Mr. Suhrawardy's allegation that Bengal was about to be put to some measure of starvation 'at the instance of the Government of India'. MSS. EUR. F. 125/138.

¹⁷ MSS. EUR. F. 125/43. ¹⁸ Not printed; but see No. 74.

a word on this subject with my colleagues individually. There was general agreement that it would be wiser, without of course making any public announcement, not for the moment to fill the vacancy, and to wait until business of such a character arose or seemed likely to arise at home as would justify our deputing a Member of Council to be present in connection with its disposal. I see no signs so far of any interest in the Press in the fact that neither a Princely nor a British Indian representative is in London; but I dare say that someone will raise the point sooner or later. I am pretty clear in my own mind that the procedure¹⁹ to which we now have it in mind to work is the wisest. It gets us over the difficulties which we are otherwise likely to experience in persuading a Member of Council to stay away from this country for any lengthy period (and given the standing and the nature of the post, I think it would be well to continue to fill it from Council). And it has the further advantage that the permanent strength of one's Council is not increased by 1, as has hitherto been the case. For the normal way of dealing with vacancies not likely to exceed a few months in duration would be to appoint a temporary Member of Council to hold the portfolio concerned while its permanent incumbent was on special duty in London.

20. Food continues to be my chief preoccupation. Azizul Haque made a very good fighting speech in the Assembly yesterday which has had a satisfactory Press. I will send you one of the Press reports on it—it brings out very effectively the extent to which Bengal in particular have themselves to thank for certain of their troubles. I am telegraphing²⁰ to let you know that the handing over of Food by Haque to Srivastava is now to take place tomorrow. Azizul Haque has worked so hard on this portfolio, and handled a very difficult question so skilfully, that I am very sorry to see him go from it. But no man can handle the three portfolios for which he is at present responsible in their present state of great activity, and the combination of Food with either Commerce or Industries and Civil Supplies would be unsatisfactory since Industries and Civil Supplies and Commerce are so very closely linked with one another.

All the best.

¹⁹ See Vol. III, Nos. 653, 666, 670, 673 and 681.

²⁰ Tel. 1698-S of 10 August. MSS. EUR. F. 125/25.

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War Cabinet W.M. (43) 111th Conclusions, Minute 1

L/F/7/687: ff 265-7; R/30/1/4: ff 127-9

Those present at this meeting held at 10 Downing Street, S.W. 1, on 4 August 1943 at 6 pm were: Mr Churchill (in the Chair), Mr Attlee, Mr Anthony Eden, Mr Oliver Lyttelton, Mr Herbert Morrison

Also present during discussion of item 1 were: Sir Kingsley Wood, Viscount Cranborne, Mr Amery, Colonel Oliver Stanley, Sir James Grigg, Sir Archibald Sinclair, Sir Stafford Cripps, Lord Leathers, Lord Woolton, Lord Cherwell, Mr Harcourt Johnstone

SHIPPING

Indian Grain Requirements

(Previous Reference: W.M. (43) 39th Conclusions)¹

The War Cabinet had before them—

- (i) A Report by the Shipping Committee on India's Requirements of Food Grains (W.P. (43) 345).²
- (ii) A Memorandum by the Secretary of State for India (W.P. (43) 349)³ on the same subject.

The Shipping Committee, in their Report, stated that a request had been received from the Government of India for 500,000 tons of wheat to be imported from September 1943 to February 1944 inclusive. The Report summarised the particulars given by the Government of India in support of this request, together with an estimate of the results which they anticipated would follow a food shortage.

After analysing the means of meeting the shortage, the Committee pointed out that—

- (i) Out of a maximum of 30,000 tons a month which could be lifted from Australia, some margin might be available for India after meeting whatever requirements for Ceylon and the Middle East might be judged necessary.
- (ii) Barley from Iraq up to 100,000 tons might be shipped against the Indian demand. Less than one-third, however, of the Indian demand could be met in these ways.

THE SECRETARY OF STATE FOR INDIA said that the Indian economy was being strained almost to breaking-point by the enormous demands made upon

¹ Not printed in Vol. III.

² No. 66.

³ No. 67.

it, as a source of supplies and men for the Army, and as a base for military operations. In January last a serious shortage had shown itself, and a request had been made for food grains to be imported into India.⁴ Later, however, the harvest had proved better than anticipated and it had been found possible to discontinue the import of grain. The Viceroy, however, had always warned him that a serious situation might arise.

One of the inherent difficulties of the position was, of course, the extreme difficulty of extracting surpluses from small producers. It was true that the 500,000 tons asked for was only 1% of India's total production. But considerably less than half the total production came into the market, and the deficit must be judged in relation to the areas and sections of the community in which the shortage had or would show itself.

There was no doubt that the present shortage of grain was connected with the inflationary position. Steps had now been taken to meet this,⁵ but it was clear that no further anti-inflationary measures instituted at this date could have any effect in extracting grain from the producers to meet the immediate situation.

The Secretary of State for India urged the War Cabinet most strongly to treat this as a very serious situation which, unless it was met, would seriously impair India's war effort.

In the view of the War Cabinet, the shortage of grain in India was not the result of physical deficiency but of hoarding, due to inflationary conditions. There was general agreement that the situation could not be dealt with simply by the importation of grain and that it must be attacked by a number of different methods. Thus:—

- (a) Adequate steps must be taken, by good propaganda in India, and by effective advertising of whatever supplies we could manage to send, to induce hoarders to release grain. It was most important to reverse the tendency which existed in one or two provinces for those in authority to encourage peasants to hold on to their grain.
- (b) Increasing attention should be paid to measures to curb inflation. In particular an endeavour should be made to make more consumer goods available. It was appreciated that this might involve switching back to the manufacture of consumer goods some of the productive capacity at present devoted to stores required for the war effort.
- (c) THE MINISTER OF WAR TRANSPORT reminded the War Cabinet that in January 1941 [1943] a demand had been made for an additional 600,000 tons of wheat, but in the result it had not been necessary to ship anything approaching this quantity. He expected that much the same would happen on this occasion. If a shortage occurred, Ceylon would feel the pinch first, and he therefore proposed that the first step should be to earmark sufficient grain for Ceylon's requirements. After the

“X” requirements of Ceylon and the Middle East had been met, it would be extremely difficult to find further ships which could be sent to Australia to fetch grain. If, however, the War Cabinet decided that some action should be taken, he thought that arrangements should now be made to import not more than 50,000 tons as a token shipment. This should, however, not be earmarked for India but should be ordered to Colombo to await instructions there. He also thought that it might be possible, as stated by the Shipping Committee, to make available up to 100,000 tons of barley from Iraq.

- (d) THE SECRETARY OF STATE FOR DOMINION AFFAIRS enquired whether, if export of wheat from the southern Dominions were to be greatly increased, it would not be necessary to send them additional fertilizers. THE MINISTER OF WAR TRANSPORT confirmed that this was so.
- (e) THE SECRETARY OF STATE FOR INDIA asked the War Cabinet not to take a firm decision to limit the help which would be afforded to India to the amount proposed by the Minister of War Transport.

The general view of the War Cabinet was that no further action should be decided upon at the present time; but that it would, of course, be open to the Secretary of State for India to raise the matter again at a later date in the light of the circumstances then existing.

The War Cabinet reached the following Conclusions:—

- (1) Approval was given to action being taken on the lines proposed by the Minister of War Transport at “X”.
- (2) The Secretary of State for India was asked to telegraph to the Government of India, urging the need for further action, on the lines suggested in discussion, to combat inflation and to induce producers to part with grain more freely.
- (3) A Standing Committee on Indian Financial Questions was appointed, comprising—

The Chancellor of the Exchequer (*in the Chair*)
 The Minister of Production
 The Secretary of State for India
 The Secretary of State for War
 The President of the Board of Trade
 The Paymaster-General

The first task which the Committee should undertake would be to consider steps to combat inflation in India. This Inquiry should cover such questions as whether some part of India's capacity, now devoted to

⁴ See Vol. III, No. 332; also Nos. 265 and 282 in that Vol.

⁵ The final version of this sentence began: ‘Steps have been taken to meet this and had already met with a definite measure of success, but it was clear . . .’ R/30/1/4: f 127.

war production, should not be switched back to the manufacture of consumer goods.

The second task the Committee should undertake would be to examine the growing indebtedness of the United Kingdom to India.⁶

⁶ Previous Reference: W.M. (43) 106th Conclusions, Minute 2 (No. 61).

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Mr Amery to the Marquess of Linlithgow

MSS. EUR. F. 125/12

PERSONAL AND SECRET

INDIA OFFICE, 5 August 1943

I thought your farewell speech¹ to the Assembly admirable in every way and am sending round copies to members of the Cabinet and of the House of Commons interested in India. But except for *The Times* I cannot say that the Press here have done justice to it. Perhaps that is not unnatural for their paper ration is very limited and anything in the nature of a connected argument is apt to be crowded out by items of hot news. Now if only you had threatened to do a "fast unto death" as the winding up of your Viceroyalty you could easily have had a page to yourself in every newspaper!

They could not have been more cross about it! Reasons (1) It was too true. (2) I did not mention Gandhi or the Congress!

L.

2. Turning to the more serious Indian food problem, I brought the matter up in Cabinet yesterday² and with not too good results. I need not tell you that I *spoke earnestly* about the dangers of the present situation. But the tendency was to treat your demand as in the main an anti-hoarder bluff and to concentrate

I wish he hadn't!

L.

on India's slowness in taking measures against inflation. Naturally I protested against this and pointed out that you had not only taken measures, but that they were already having their effect and that nothing that you could do in Indian conditions could wholly counteract the tendencies set up by your vast purchases from India with no sufficient absorption of the money thus let loose either by import or by domestic production of consumer goods. In the end all they would commit themselves to at present was 100,000 tons of barley from Iraq and 50,000 tons of wheat to go to Colombo to be used for Ceylon or India as the situation demanded. The idea is that without disclosing figures you might at any rate, on the strength of this, announce that substantial

amounts are coming in as required. I had to accept, but pointed out that I might be compelled by events to reopen the matter within a very few weeks.

3. Cabinet also decided to set up under the Chancellor of the Exchequer a Committee including Oliver Lyttelton, Minister of Production, Dalton of the Board of Trade, Grigg and Professor Lord Cherwell with myself to consider both the immediate problem of inflation and the long-term problem of the accumulating sterling balances. On the whole I welcomed this as it may give me a better opportunity of educating these particular members of the Cabinet than one gets at a full-dress Cabinet meeting, while they in their turn may exercise a useful influence on Winston who is, I think, anyhow beginning to have a somewhat clearer idea of the nature of these problems.

4. I hope in any case to send you a telegram with some further suggestions, from our office point of view, on the subject of inflation. I still feel grave misgivings as to your Government's cautiousness in dealing with the rate of interest. My own inclination would be to issue a new loan with a big drive behind it at 5 per cent. for the big investor and to start a new Savings Bank or small savers loan based partially on a fairly low rate of interest, e.g. 3 or 4 per cent. but with a substantial prize-giving element included. The natural gambling instinct of humanity is one which has its value and which you cannot afford to neglect at a time like this. Besides the poor man who saves a few hundred rupees is likely not to waste a thousand rupees prize if he should be lucky enough to get it. A further advantage of the prize system is that the luck of individual recipients can be made the subject of press propaganda, not to speak of oral rumour, calculated to make the investment much more attractive than it really is. The prizes might, of course, be only partly paid outright now and the rest deferred until later. However, you will have had my more carefully thought out views in telegraph form before this reaches you.

P.S.V.—

*I put this to F[inance] M[ember].
I think he is getting on a little with
plans for a prize loan.*

L.

5. Another thing that has occurred to me is whether this is not a great opportunity for getting a corporation like De Beers' to sell large quantities of diamonds in India and possibly to get other jewellers to co-operate. That is a form of import that requires no shipping to speak of and might, given Indian tastes and habits, draw quite a lot of redundant money off the market.

*If this is so easy, why hasn't it
occurred to De Beers!*

L.

¹ See No. 68, note 2.

² No. 71.

6. Winston is off once more³ and I can only hope that he will now be able to settle on a Supreme Commander as well as on the general character of South East Asia operations in the near future. On all these matters I very much appreciate the helpful way in which Auchinleck has met this difficult and complicated question of relations between Commander-in-Chief, India, and the future Supreme Command. The further question of the Viceroy's Resident Minister capacity and Staff for that purpose will, I imagine, await Winston's return and for the immediate present we have been only dealing with that side of it which affects F.E.B., &c.

I am so glad and quite agree.

L.

7. With regard to Raisman, Maxwell, Twynam and Pilditch, it is, as you realize, difficult to give any present assurances. Wavell will undoubtedly wish to keep a free hand till he has had time to look round, though I quite agree that he ought to make up his mind on some of these points by the end of the year. I will certainly mention your high opinion of Twynam to him. I should also imagine that he would be likely to want to keep on Pilditch.

8. I hope by the way myself to stay away from the Office most of the week for the next two weeks. I hope very much, therefore, that Gandhi and his friends will not start any sort of trouble on the 9th which will interfere with this. Last year I had similarly planned a fortnight but never got away before Thursday any week.

Trust you have a nice holiday.

L.

9. Bevin is very anxious to have some further talks with Wavell and myself in September on the question of Indian social progress. The last memorandum⁴ you enclosed struck me as a little over-pessimistic, though I fully realise all the difficulties and have been doing what I can to press them on our sanguine people like Cripps and Bevin. Also I entirely agree that if anything can be done, it should show itself in action, and that nothing could have a worse effect than our announcement from this end that a new policy of social reform is to be pressed from here in order to keep Indian politicians quiet.

The missionaries' appeal⁵ is a tame and inconclusive document. It admits that you cannot negotiate with people who are not prepared to work on constitutional lines and then goes on to advocate a constituent assembly based apparently on the existing elected members in the Provinces. So far as public education is concerned, it would have been much better to publish McKenzie's private letter,⁶ though even that tails off at the end.

³ On 4 August, Mr Churchill left London to attend the Anglo-American Conference at Quebec which, amongst other matters, discussed plans for the invasion of France and the establishment

of the South East Asia Command. On 1 September Mr Churchill left Canada for further discussions with the President in Washington. He returned to Britain on 19 September.

⁴ See No. 52, note 5.

⁵ See No. 53, note 12.

⁶ See No. 53, note 14.

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Sir B. Glancy (Punjab) to the Marquess of Linlithgow (Extract)

MSS. EUR. F. 125/92

PRIVATE AND PERSONAL "BARNES COURT", SIMLA, 6 August 1943
No. 465.

Dear Lord Linlithgow,

Increased activities by Muslim Leaguers have led to further uneasiness in Ministerial and political circles. Captain Shaukat Hyat Khan's unpardonably indiscreet references to "Pakistan"¹ in the course of his recent tour came near to bringing matters to a head. His perambulations, as you are aware, have now been brought to an abrupt conclusion, but he has done enough to show that little, if any, reliance can be placed on his loyalty to his Leader. He has not entirely made up his mind whether to pose as the Repentant Sinner or the Injured Innocent: in the latter rôle he is sadly unconvincing and has met with no official applause. League newspapers, incited by Shaukat's vagaries, clamour more loudly than ever for a declaration that the Unionist Party is at an end, and a mischievous and unedifying controversy has been raging round the question whether the party in power is a creation of the League or a Coalition or a combination or merely a Union. There is a general demand that the Premier should come out into the open and make his position clear. It seems likely that he will be driven to do so as the result of the forthcoming Muslim League meeting at Delhi. The Premier is, I gather, determined to take his stand on the Sikander-Jinnah Pact² and to insist on retaining the term "Unionist" or "Unionist Coalition" (both of which expressions figure in the Pact) as the correct designation of his Party. His intentions are likely to be indicated to Jinnah before the meeting takes place. If Jinnah adopts a moderate line and decides not to force the issue, the existing truce may continue indefinitely. But, if he is set on pressing for outright subservience to the Muslim League, it is quite on the cards the Premier will conclude that his correct course is to resign, rather than see his Muslim followers gradually fading over into opposition under stress of promises and threats. I most sincerely hope that Jinnah's intransigence will not bring matters to this pass. It may be unlikely enough

¹ See No. 55, note 2.

² Concluded at a meeting of the All-India Muslim League at Lucknow, 15 October 1937. It secured Muslim League support for the Punjab Unionist ministry.

that his supporters could at present succeed in working up a majority in the Punjab Assembly, but each of the main communities as represented in the House contains a fairly large proportion of unstable elements, and in many cases it would be rash to assume that public interest would prevail over personal considerations. Even if it be taken for granted that the deadlock would be of short duration and would eventually result in the return of stragglers to the Unionist fold, it is disquieting to think that a pre-eminently Muslim Government, which, whatever its defects, has carried on for so many years with reasonable efficiency, should now collapse through the machinations of the Qaid-i-Azam and be replaced by a system of administration set up under Section 93 of the Act.

2. The Congress party have shown very little liveliness of late and there is not much prospect of their successfully staging any serious disturbances in the Punjab on the approaching anniversary of last year's sensational adventure. Precautions have, however, been taken, and Railway security measures are being brought into force in the south-east of the Province. The Hindu Press has naturally displayed considerable anxiety about the chances of the Ministry subordinating themselves to the Muslim League, and there have been various attempts to effect a better understanding between Hindus and Sikhs.

3. The Akalis have been busy defending their position against assault. Master Tara Singh and Giani Kartar Singh have visited Simla and I have had a fairly long talk with them. It appears that, in spite of their almost incessant complaints that the Sikander-Baldev Pact³ is being disregarded, they realise that much has been done in fulfilment of its intentions. A statement has been made by Master Tara Singh that his party will have nothing to do with a Muslim League Ministry, but it is a matter of opinion how far he would abide by this declaration if offered a substantial inducement to march in the opposite direction. His main interest is centred at present in a Bill for the Amendment of the Gurdwaras Act⁴ whereby he hopes that he and his associates on the Shiromani Gurdwara Prabandhak Committee⁵ will acquire control of revenues now in the hands of various Local Committees and will be allowed in the alleged interests of the Panth an increased degree of latitude in the general disposal of religious funds.

³ See No. 49, note 2.

⁴ *The Sikh Gurdwaras Act* (Punjab Act VIII of 1925) provided for the registration of Sikh temples and rules for their management.

⁵ A committee established in 1920 for the central management of Sikh shrines. It later became the centre of Sikh politics.

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Mr Amery to the Marquess of Linlithgow

Telegram, L/E/8/3322: f 253

IMPORTANT

INDIA OFFICE, 7 August 1943, 6.40 am

PERSONAL

17601. Your personal telegram of 29th July, No. 1601-S.¹ Food imports. Cabinet have now considered² your request for 500,000 tons of wheat and utmost that they are prepared to concede now is as follows:

(a) Subject to supply arrangements being feasible (Ministry of Food are taking this up), shipping to be provided for up to 100,000 tons of barley from Iraq, spread over reasonable period.

(b) Tonnage sufficient to lift 50,000 tons of wheat from Australia to be moved into position (there is none in position now and transfer will take about three months) but question whether it should be sent to India or some other Indian Ocean destination to be decided later. This decision is based on general admission that Indian Ocean area as a whole is under-tonnaged.

2. Cabinet were very impressed by seriousness of general economic position and urged especially necessity of further efforts to counter inflationary factors (in particular by endeavouring to make more consumer goods available), of inducing hoarders to release grain by forceful propaganda, including effective advertising of whatever supplies may become assured (though without mention of quantities), and of eliminating any remaining tendency among Provincial authorities to encourage peasants to hold on to their grain. It was decided to set up at once ministerial standing committee under chairmanship of Chancellor of the Exchequer, whose initial task should be to consider the economic and financial position of India as a whole from the standpoint of combating inflation. I shall of course keep the food position before this Committee as part of wider problem. Meanwhile I fear that above reply affords no basis for any immediate public announcement.

¹ No. 65.

² No. 71.

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The Marquess of Linlithgow to Sir J. Herbert (Bengal)

Telegram, MSS. EUR. F. 125/43

MOST IMMEDIATE

8 August 1943

PERSONAL

No. 1686-S. I deal below with a variety of matters in connection with the Bengal position which are causing me much uneasiness, and on which I should welcome your very early comment.

2. I am disturbed in the first place by reports I receive of the inefficiency of the Calcutta Corporation; the state of the streets, non-collection of refuse, weakness of water supply, &c. I seem to have had no report from you on this subject, or any reference in any letter prior to your letter of 5th August.¹ I shall be grateful for a telegraphic report giving your own judgment of the seriousness of the position and the extent to, and means by which it is remediable. We may have to consider taking a very firm hand with the Corporation, and I would wish your report to cover that.

3. Finance Member has represented to me very strongly the critical financial position into which your Government is drifting owing to its reluctance to face up to the necessity of imposing taxation; its failure to co-operate in anti-inflationary measures, even in areas where money is admittedly flowing freely, &c. I recognise that war conditions have placed a heavy burden on Bengal and that you have had to cope with cyclones and other serious natural disasters. But the Province has not imposed further substantial taxation, though the scope for it exists, and has remained content with revenue deficits of a crore to a crore and a half while insistently demanding ways and means advance and grants from the Centre. The latest request for eight crores ways and means advance has been refused pending certain assurances from your Government. I shall welcome your comment on position to which there has been no reference of importance in any of your recent reports.

4. I am disturbed also to hear reports (which I recognise may be incorrect) that Birla and the Marwaris have apparently been allowed by your Government to take over a substantial responsibility for opening communal kitchens in Calcutta, selling rice at concession rates, &c. I have had no report from you on this subject, and no comment on the serious reflection on your Government which the existence of this state of things if correct would represent, for you will realise the extent to which it would admit of being regarded as an abdication by Government of its functions. Please let me have a full telegraphic report as to the facts, with your comments if these suggestions are well-founded.

5. I am bound to add my sense of most uneasiness at handling by your Government of the food problem. (You should see in that connection Wood's letter to Suhrawardy of 3rd August.)² Thus they sent up no one until I addressed you personally to the recent Conference. I recognise your difficulties. But I cannot resist the feeling that greater energy and drive, and better administrative organisation, are called for. Are you satisfied that Ayyar (who for your entirely personal information did not I gather greatly impress the Food Policy Committee) has the personality and resolution required? I am sending you Kirby to help over rationing. But the Provinces were warned months ago of the possibility of rationing; problem is I should have thought eased in Bengal by rationing schemes of European firms, and I would have expected a scheme to have been worked out long ago. In the same connection I gather from my Food Department that there is reason for serious complaint at your Government's handling of the control and distribution of sugar in Bengal. Are you satisfied as to the administrative arrangements for dealing with this?

6. You will understand in the light of the above that I am far from happy about present situation in Bengal, and I would be grateful for very early report on points I have mentioned.

¹ MSS. EUR. F. 125/43.

² See No. 70, note 16.

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Sir J. Herbert (Bengal) to the Marquess of Linlithgow

MSS. EUR. F. 125/43

GOVT. HOUSE, CALCUTTA, 10 August 1943

Dear Linlithgow,

I write in reply to your personal telegram No. 1686-S, dated the 9th [? 8th] August 1943, and in continuation of my personal telegram No. 127,¹ dated the 10th August 1943.

2. The reference in my letter of the 5th August² to the inefficiency of the Calcutta Corporation was not intended to imply inactivity on the part of Government in the civic sphere. In actual fact the new Government have taken vigorous action to deal with the present state of affairs. Extra petrol has been supplied to enable the afternoon conservancy clearances to be made throughout the city, and this has improved the condition of the streets. Assistance is being given to the Corporation in obtaining spare parts for those conservancy vehicles which are at present unusable. Under the Bengal

¹ and ² MSS. EUR. F. 125/43.

Vagrancy Ordinance, 1943, 359 beggars have been rounded up, and further action continues daily. Many others have left the city fearing arrest, and these steps have brought about a welcome change for the better. For the purpose of increasing the city's water supply Government have issued 10 directions to the Corporation regarding the repair and improvement of boilers, turbines and filter beds, and the Corporation have agreed to comply with these. Further measures to increase the Corporation's efficiency are under examination in the light of Gurner's recent report on the Corporation's finances, and I hope that it may be possible to evolve such measures shortly. The Calcutta Municipal Act, 1923, does not empower the Provincial Government to supersede the Corporation, and supersession is likely to result in such far-reaching political repercussions that I doubt whether any Bengal Ministry will have the courage to introduce, or whether the Bengal Legislature will ever agree to pass, the legislation required to arm Government with the necessary powers. Our present intention, therefore, is to issue directions under Section 17 of that Act, with the object of taking action under Section 18 if these directions are not complied with to the satisfaction of Government. The powers conferred by Section 18 are limited in scope, but could be made quite considerable in effect, and I am inclined to think that they are perhaps sufficient for the time being.

3. As regards the financial position, you will see from my fortnightly reports for the first and second halves of January last³ that the Huq Ministry accepted additional taxation proposals amounting to Rs. 33 lakhs, but rejected the proposed doubling of the provincial Sales Tax, which was estimated to bring in Rs. 50 lakhs. The former proposals were approved by the legislature and are embodied in the Bengal Finance Act, 1943, my assent to which was published on the 15th April of this year. You will appreciate that taxation proposals, which must involve legislation, must also in a Ministerial Province involve political considerations, and that the communal effect of an agricultural income-tax is likely to be considerable in a Province where most of the landlords are Hindus. The first obligation of the present Ministry, which took office on the 24th April, was to pass the existing budget. The passage of the budget was obstructed in July by the ruling of the Speaker of the Legislative Assembly, and we have asked for the advice of your Government in regard to the best method of extricating ourselves from the present impasse. I feel that it is impossible for the present Ministry to meet the legislature with taxation proposals until it has succeeded in getting the budget through. On the other hand, I entirely agree with the necessity for additional taxation, and proposals for doubling the Sales Tax and imposing an agricultural income-tax will be considered in Cabinet on the 12th August next.

4. As regards anti-inflation measures, I would ask you to see my Chief Secretary's letter, dated the 2nd August 1943,⁴ to Griffiths, in which the Bengal

Government's attitude towards the proposed savings drive is set out in detail. We feel that the Government of India's assumptions cannot altogether apply to Bengal where, notwithstanding increased avenues of employment in certain areas, standards of living have generally been depressed more than elsewhere. We consider that the repayment of loans is the first requirement, and instructions were issued about one month ago to all District Officers to expedite the collection of loans and to encourage the payment of arrears of rent.

5. Turning to the food situation, I feel myself that Ayyar is a sound man. I should have preferred a European officer for the post of Director, but Pinnell, who held the appointment for some time, broke down under the strain of it, and we are so short of good European officers of the necessary calibre and experience that we have not been able to find a substitute. The rationing schemes of the European firms, for the introduction of which I personally pressed, have undoubtedly eased the general problem of rationing. Nevertheless, the problem remains considerable, and the working out of details for the rationing of a great city like Calcutta, with its attendant industrial area, is bound to take time. As I pointed out in my letter of the 5th August, we have not been able to utilise the Corporation services in the way that we should like, but nevertheless much preliminary work has been done. Stevens carried through successfully the food census, which was taken on the 7th and 8th August, and with Kirby's assistance, he is now preparing final plans for complete rationing.

6. That portion of your telegram which relates to "control" has been received in an incomplete form. I understand from Williams, however, that it relates to the control of wheat prices and sugar distribution. I shall investigate the administrative arrangements which have been made for dealing with these two subjects and will let you have a further report regarding them later on.

7. It has always been the practice in Bengal to encourage philanthropic and charitable assistance in times of scarcity, and in accordance with this principle our Civil Supplies Department issued instructions some time ago to the effect that Government would provide foodgrains at concession rates to philanthropic organisations for distribution in the Calcutta area and outside, provided that certain conditions were fulfilled. These conditions were, that the organisation should supply a list of persons to whom distribution would be made, that it should observe a prescribed quantity and quality for the food to be distributed, that not more than one meal *per diem* should be distributed to one individual, and that Government should exercise general supervision over the location and administration of distribution centres. It is in terms of these instructions that the distribution of gruel by various organisations

³ MSS. EUR. F. 125/43.

⁴ Not printed.

(including Birla and certain Marwaris) is being carried out; and all these arrangements are under official supervision. In this view of the matter I do not myself think that arrangements of this kind can reasonably be thought to constitute a reflection upon Government's ability to distribute food or an abdication of functions properly appertaining to itself.

Yours sincerely,

J. A. HERBERT

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The Marquess of Linlithgow to Mr Amery

Telegram, MSS. EUR. F. 125/25

IMMEDIATE

NEW DELHI, 12 August 1943, 1.40 pm

PERSONAL

Received: 12 August, 12.30 pm

No. 1721-S. Following a series of editorials critical of our policy as expounded in my speech¹ to Legislature, *News Chronicle* in highly critical leading article is today quoted at length by Reuters. After usual patter about futility of inviting incarcerated leaders to confer together leading article proceeds to describe Government of India as virtual dictatorship. I must warn you that this failure to mobilise the slightest support in any British newspaper for the policy of His Majesty's Government and Government of India, which policy commands the unanimous support of my Executive Council, and to get such favourable comment transmitted to India, is damaging to our position here and seriously discouraging to our supporters. I am convinced that our policy commands widespread public support in the United Kingdom, and I am unable to resist the conclusion that the position complained of points to a serious failure of your propaganda and publicity machine. Again I would have thought that your own great influence with key men in the newspaper world might well have insured us against this purely negative reaction amongst papers ordinarily favourable to Government policy. Incidentally I hope you may take some early opportunity to remind people that our withdrawal from the business of constitution-making in favour of Indians themselves is due to Indians' insistence that nothing will induce them to accept any constitution not drawn up by themselves.

¹ See No. 68, note 2.

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*The Marquess of Linlithgow to Mr Amery**Telegram, MSS. EUR. F. 125/25*

IMMEDIATE

NEW DELHI, 13 August 1943, 6.5 pm

PERSONAL

Received: 13 August, 5.30 pm

No. 1742-S. Your personal telegram of 7th August, No. 17601.¹ Food imports. I fully appreciate difficulties that confront the Cabinet. But I am bound in duty to represent critical nature of the difficulties that will face us here unless decision contained in your telegram is modified. A firm promise of 100,000 tons of barley and the possibility of small additional quantity of wheat will go nowhere in meeting our essential demands, and after consultation and in full agreement with Commander-in-Chief, Finance Member and Food Member, I am bound in terms to warn the Cabinet that the Government of India and I cannot be responsible for the continuing stability of India now, or for her capacity to serve as a base against Japan next year unless we have appropriate help in prospect. You will be familiar from the Press with the critical situation that faces us in Bengal. And distinct signs are beginning to emerge that the wheat position in the Punjab is hardening against us with higher prices and a diminishing flow from the cultivators to the markets. The addition of the transport breakdown owing to the very major breaches in communication with Eastern India which have followed on the recent floods, and which there is no hope of our being able to remedy effectively under at least a couple of months has further aggravated situation and brought out vital importance of being able to run food directly to Calcutta by sea (I would put assistance by way of putting foodgrains into Calcutta at minimum of two ships or fifteen thousand tons a month; and I would classify this as a security operation essential to the lines of communication of the Army). On the general Food position I can only repeat what has already been said in my personal telegram of 29th July, No. 1601-S,² and convey to His Majesty's Government in the most formal manner possible the considered warning given earlier in this telegram. If they are not prepared to modify their decision we here can take no responsibility for the consequences. And it is essential that that should be fully understood at this stage, and fact that what is in issue is not merely feeding India, but our capacity to wage war against Japan.

¹ No. 74.² No. 65.

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The Marquess of Linlithgow to Mr Amery

Telegram, MSS. EUR. F. 125/25

IMMEDIATE

13 August 1943

PRIVATE AND PERSONAL

No. 1743-S. Please see my personal telegram of today. Food Imports. Cabinet do not seem to realise seriousness of position and I must make it perfectly clear to you that if they stick to their guns they must carry full responsibility whether in terms of difficulty of basing forthcoming operations on India or of internal conditions in this country. If you want further ammunition let me know, and let me know equally if there is any way in which I can make my personal telegram more effective or further strengthen your hands. We feel very strongly here that Cabinet are closing their eyes to seriousness of considerations urged in my personal telegram of 29th July¹ and, as I have made clear, my present personal telegram has full support of the Chief on the Military side, as well as of Finance and Food Members.

¹ No. 65.

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Mrs Hendy to Mr Raman¹

MSS. EUR. F. 125/130

Undated

Dear Mr Raman,

Our good friend who heard Ambassador Phillips speak to the group at Harvard that you will be addressing on Wednesday has suggested the following approach for you.

I. How is India governed?

P. said that it was governed by four men—Churchill, Amery, the Viceroy and the Commander-in-Chief. He said that the Viceroy's Council is a rubber stamp and the Provincial Governors dictators. That Churchill and Amery know nothing of India except what the Viceroy tells them. That the old Guard of Provincial Governors is still completely Victorian in outlook and does not want to grant Indian independence, and that the trappings of democracy, as far as they exist, are only a kind of modern frosting of the old Imperial cake.

2. Can the British maintain the *status quo* until the war is won?

P. said they could not—that the situation was deteriorating and that the lid would blow off. He was truly worried about this, particularly of course with reference to the large American army which is out on a limb there and might get cut off. He said he knew the British believed they could hold things steady, but he did not agree with them, and thought their Blimpishness blinded them to the danger.

3. How could Indian independence be achieved?

P. said that the British believed that withdrawal or any other move now would mean a blood-bath, or pretended to believe it—he did not. He is all for starting now by making the Viceroy's Council real, by putting on it men chosen by Indians, and giving them real power; a real Cabinet instead of a rubber stamp. And the second thing he urged was a proclamation by the King-Emperor saying that he really had the independence of India at heart.

As I told you, he made it plain that he deplored the Indian leaders' imprisonment without once referring to the reason why they are in prison, or how they could get out. I suspect that 99 per cent. of his audience thinks that they are simply imprisoned because they would not accept the Cripps' proposals.

Well, that is quite a lot to get into twenty minutes—but there will be questions; and Phillips got his into twenty minutes!

I hope these notes will be of some use to you; if you can make this group understand something of the truth about India it will be worth it, as they are pretty important, and their net spreads rather wise [wide?].

Sincerely yours,

KYKIE [?KYTHÉ] HENDY

¹ Enclosed in letter 1032 of 14 August from Mr Hennessy (Information Officer to the Indian Agent General in the United States) to Sir G. Laithwaite.

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Mr Amery to the Marquess of Linlithgow

Telegram, L/I/1/219: ff 242-5

IMMEDIATE

INDIA OFFICE, 15 August 1943, 1.45 am

PERSONAL

Received: 15 August

18359. Your telegram dated 12 August, 1721-S.¹ I fully share your concern over the line taken editorially by the *News Chronicle*, *Daily Herald*, *Manchester Guardian*, and *Glasgow Herald*. But you seriously misjudge the situation when

you infer that these editorials indicate “a failure to mobilise the slightest support in any British newspaper . . .” The fact that only four such articles have so far appeared in a British Press of over a 100 daily newspapers—and those in organs always disposed to be critical—cannot be termed unsatisfactory or discouraging.

2. Overwhelming majority of newspapers in this country, truly reflecting public opinion generally, have consistently recognised the difficulties inherent in the political situation in India, and that particularly in view of paramount importance of defence of India to successful prosecution of the war there is no practical alternative to policy of H.M.G. and Government of India (and particularly the measures taken to deal with the Civil Disobedience Movement and the Congress leaders).

3. In these circumstances (and having regard to the quite outstanding developments in the war situation which coincided with your address to the Legislature), I am sure you will recognise that there was no particular call, on the occasion of your address, for the newspapers here to launch out into a new defence, editorially, of your policy which has of course all along commanded general acceptance both in Parliament and in the Press.

4. Nevertheless I am equally disappointed at the lack of publicity in this country for your address. Factors beyond the control of my Information Department (on which I am sorry that, in the absence of full appreciation of the position, you have passed so severe a censure) operating against adequate attention were referred to in some detail in No. 17589² dated 6th August from my Adviser on Publicity to your Private Secretary. I am sure that, in spite of the difficulties, the steps which my Information Department would have taken as a matter of course if they had had any warning of your address, or, better still, if they had had a summary of it in advance, would not have been altogether fruitless. As it was, they had no opportunity whatsoever either to stimulate publicity for the address or to suggest to the host of friendly editors with whom they are in touch that editorial support would be timely. The lesson, quite frankly, is that, given the most favourable circumstances, one cannot afford to allow any policy speech, whether made in India or in this country, to drift through on newspaper tapes and take it for granted that, without special measures, it will receive adequate treatment, especially in these days of restrictions on newspaper space, either in the news columns or editorially.

² L/I/I/219.